

The Clearing and the Lodge

A plain-language privacy guide for community families

Community:

your community name

THE CLEARING

The Clearing is the bounded gathering place your community keeps together — the Sandbox board. It holds this week's park days, field trips, asks, meetups, and the small news of the neighbourhood. Invitations are single-use. Posts reset each Sunday at midnight. The organizer can see everything on the board. No one outside your community can.

THE LODGE

The Lodge is your private home — Saltbox, on your own device. Portfolios, day notes, curricula, and family records live entirely on your device. Nothing leaves unless you open the door yourself. The Eave is the line between the Lodge and the Clearing: what stays below the Eave stays private.

THE KEY ON THE HOOK — SESSIONS

Signing in hangs a key on the hook. It stays there for 30 days. If a device is lost or handed to someone outside the household, go to Settings and choose *Sign out all devices* — this changes the lock immediately. Every active session stops working. Then sign in fresh from your own device.

THE MAILBOX — SUNDAY DIGEST

Your email address has your name on it and sits at the edge of the property — visible from the road. Add it in Settings to receive a warm summary each Sunday when the fresh board opens. Remove it any time. Removed means gone: it won't appear in the next digest. Your email is stored encrypted on the server.

THREE SIMPLE HABITS

Lock your screen when you set your device down. **Sign out** before passing your phone to someone outside your household. If you notice unfamiliar posts or activity, **tell your organizer the same day**.

ZONE IDENTITY AND ADDRESS HYGIENE

When you set up a zone identity in your settings, the tooling handles address rotation automatically — a fresh derived address is used for every send and every receive, so the same address never appears twice on-chain. Resting and standby are two states of the same master key root: you cannot have two separate zone identities, one for resting and one for participating. Your master key never leaves the device — it is encrypted with your passphrase and stored only locally.

THE COVERED WAGON ROUTE — VPNs

A VPN changes the road, not the destination. Your internet provider (Rogers, Bell, Cogeco) sees you connect to the VPN — not where you went after. Sites you visit see the VPN's address, not yours. The VPN provider itself sees everything. They are your new road.

What a VPN does not do: protect a device that is already compromised at the OS level — spyware reads your data before it is encrypted, before it leaves. Prevent tracking once you log into an account. Make free services private — free VPNs have a business model, and it is usually your data.

Canada is a Five Eyes country (intelligence sharing with the US, UK, Australia, New Zealand). VPN providers in Five Eyes jurisdictions can be served legal orders requiring them to log and hand over your traffic. Many have. Providers in Switzerland or with independently verified no-logs audits are a meaningfully safer choice.

THE CANADIAN LEGAL LANDSCAPE

VPNs are currently legal in Canada. **Bill C-26** (An Act respecting cybersecurity), introduced 2022 and still in Senate review as of 2025, gives the federal government broad authority to compel telecommunications providers to take "security-related" actions — including

WHAT'S STORED WHERE

	The Clearing	The Lodge	The Mailbox
What	Board posts, events, sections	Curricula, portfolios, notes	Your email address
Who holds it	Your community	Your device	Server, encrypted
Who can see	Members only	Your household	Organizer (digest only)
Reset?	Every Sunday	You control	Remove in Settings

VPN PROVIDER COMPARISON

Provider	Based	No-logs audit	Free tier
ProtonVPN	Switzerland	Independent	Yes
Mullvad	Sweden	Independent	No (cash OK)
Free VPNs	Various	Often none	Yes

Switzerland and Sweden are not Five Eyes members. An independently verified no-logs policy means the provider cannot hand over browsing history even if ordered to. Avoid any VPN whose business model is unclear.

METAPHOR KEY

The Clearing — Sandbox — the community board

The Lodge — Saltbox — your private device

The Eave — Privacy boundary between household and community

The key on the hook — Your session — 30 days, or changed by Sign out all devices

The mailbox — Your email — at the edge, visible from the road

The covered wagon route — A VPN — changes the road, not the destination

QUESTIONS?

Ask your community organizer. They hold the invite keys